



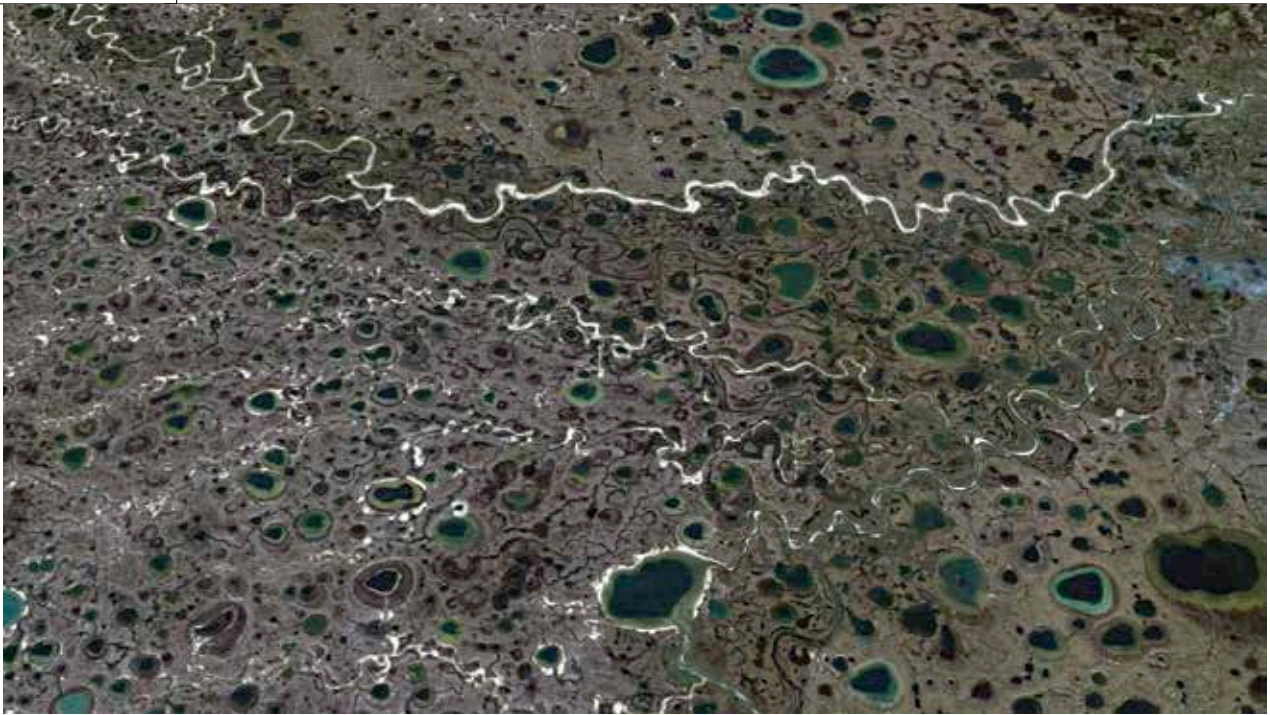
2017 among the hottest years

2017 was the hottest year since 1880, when global temperatures started being recorded
<http://digit.in/2017heat>



Coral reefs at breaking point

The head of UNEP has said that serious steps must be taken to save the threatened coral reefs.
<http://digit.in/coralbreak>



Siberian permafrost explosions

Craters appearing in the northern reaches of the Russian tundra are a large scale environmental disaster with repercussions far beyond the sudden holes in the ground.

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THE END OF THE LAND

A nomadic reindeer herder in the remote Russian arctic was going about his day in the Yamal peninsula, a name that means “the end of the land”. Suddenly, the ground erupted with a loud explosion, sending flames shooting towards the sky. The reindeer and the dogs bolted in fear, running away from the site of the explosion. The confused

herder was left alone in the tundra, holding a reindeer calf in his hands.

In the Yamal region, the locals have been reporting the mysterious phenomena since 2013. There are tremors in the ground, loud noises heard upto hundred kilometers away, entire hills vanish, craters appear suddenly in the ground, there is a glow in the sky, columns of fire, and clouds of billowing black smoke. In the aftermath of these mysterious explosions, mounds of soil, sand and ice

is scattered for up to a one kilometer radius around the crater. At times, the craters keep growing in size after the initial formation. At other times, the terrain is tortured with irregular features, including rapidly expanding ravines. The craters have names such as “big bang”, or “pillar of fire”. The Siberian Times has been consistently reporting on the phenomenon.

Initial theories on what was causing the explosions included meteor impact events and missile strikes. Some suspected that pranksters were behind the craters. For conspiracy theorists, the explanations ranged from aliens to secretive underground facilities collapsing. The most famous crater is a tourist destination, and is known as the Yamal crater. As the site of the explosion was close to a river, the river flowed into it, forming a natural funnel.

The craters are primarily appearing in the Yamal and Gydan peninsulas, both in the Yamalo-Nenets Autonomous Okrug, well within the arctic circle. The twin peninsulas jut out into the Kara sea. The region is pockmarked with crater shaped lakes, and the satellite imagery from the area is a nightmare for those suffering from tryphobia. Beneath the ground